SCHEME OF VALUATION
MG4DSCHIS200 - HISTORY OF MODERN KERALA
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION, MARCH 2026
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)
Maximum Marks: 70

Examiners must award marks only for accurate historical facts, logical presentation and relevant points. No deduction is made for minor spelling or grammatical errors when the content is satisfactory. Students are expected to attempt at least one question from each course outcome. Part A carries 2 marks per question and expects 3–4 crisp points in short sentences. Part B carries 5 marks per question and requires a brief introduction, main arguments and a short conclusion. Part C carries 10 marks per question and demands a clear structure with introduction, detailed body and conclusion.

PART A – Short Answer Questions (Any 10 × 2 = 20 marks)

1) Tuhafat-ul-Mujahiddin is an Arabic historical work written in 1583 by Zainuddin Makhdoom II of Ponnani. It records Portuguese atrocities in Malabar from 1498 to 1583. The text highlights resistance by Mappila Muslims, Kunjali Marakkars and the Zamorin of Calicut. It is the first authentic native source on 16th-century Kerala and calls for jihad against the Portuguese.
2) Marthanda Varma's "Blood and Iron" policy meant the use of force and warfare to centralise power in Travancore. He crushed the Ettuveetil Pillamar and internal rivals. He modernised the army with European help under Capt. De Lannoy. The policy established absolute monarchy and royal monopoly over trade.
3) The Third Anglo-Mysore War was fought from 1790 to 1792 between Tipu Sultan and the British-led alliance. Tipu's attack on Travancore and suppression of Malabar rebellions triggered the war. The Treaty of Seringapatam in 1792 forced Tipu to cede Malabar to the British. This strengthened British control over the pepper trade in Kerala.
4) Paliath Achan was the hereditary Prime Minister of Cochin. In 1808–09 Govindan Achan allied with Velu Thampi against the British subsidiary alliance. He led Nair forces to attack British Resident Col. Macaulay's residence and freed prisoners. The revolt was suppressed and Paliath Achan was exiled.
5) Sambandham was a traditional non-sacramental marriage system followed by Namboothiri and allied communities in matrilineal Kerala. The alliance was temporary and the Nair woman stayed in her taravad. Children belonged to the mother's lineage and the husband had no property rights. The system declined under colonial influence and reform movements.
6) Colonial law reinforced patriarchy by applying Victorian norms to matrilineal customs. The Malabar Marriage Act of 1896 and Nair Regulation of 1925 ended marumakkathayam. These laws promoted nuclear families and individual male property rights. They weakened women's position in the taravad and shifted society towards patriliny and monogamy.
7) Dr P Palpu used petition writings as a public form of historical narration. He blended community grievances with alternative histories such as ancient Buddhist Kerala versus Brahminical domination. The petitions served as tools for Ezhava mobilisation and rights demands. This style became an early form of modern historiography in Kerala.

8) Dr P Palpu acted as a petition writer by submitting repeated memorials to the Diwan and Viceroy. He demanded education, government jobs and temple entry for Ezhavas. His writings constructed a collective Ezhava identity based on historical injustice. The petitions directly paved the way for the SNDP Yogam and the anti-caste movement in Travancore.
9) Payyannur Satyagraha was the 1930 Salt Satyagraha centre in Malabar led by K. Kelappan. The march from Kozhikode to Payyannur broke the salt law at Uliyath Kadavu. British forces raided the camp. It was called the Second Bardoli and boosted the Civil Disobedience Movement across Kerala.
10) "Niranam Pada" refers to the violent anti-communist militia active during the 1959 Vimochana Samaram in Kerala. It operated mainly in Kuttanad and was backed by church and landlord interests. The group attacked communists and supporters opposing land reforms. It symbolised organised resistance to the first elected communist ministry.
11) Malabar district was merged with Travancore-Cochin under the States Reorganisation Act of 1956. The merger created a single Malayalam-speaking Kerala state on 1 November 1956. It achieved linguistic and administrative unity for the entire Malayalam region.
12) Teachers' organisations emerged in Malabar in the early 20th century along with western education and social reforms. Groups such as the Malabar Teachers Association demanded better pay and service conditions. They linked their demands to anti-feudal and nationalist struggles. Their efforts expanded public education and accelerated social change.

PART B – Short Essay Questions (Any 6 × 5 = 30 marks)

13) The Attingal Revolt of 1721 was the first major anti-British uprising in Kerala at the Anjengo factory. Economic grievances included the Company's pepper monopoly, corrupt practices and forced labour. Local chiefs rose against political interference and atrocities. The British suppressed the revolt but it forced them to shift focus to Travancore.
14) Shakthan Thampuran consolidated power in Cochin between 1790 and 1805 by ending feudal anarchy. He curbed the influence of powerful nobles including the Paliath Achan. He centralised administration and planned the modern town of Thrissur. He promoted the Thrissur Pooram festival to unite communities while balancing British relations.
15) Colonial exchange integrated Kerala into the global capitalist economy through spice exports. The shift from subsistence agriculture to cash-crop production created export dependency. British agency houses and land-revenue changes deepened inequalities. Infrastructure such as roads and ports developed but long-term economic dependence also grew.
16) Western education acted as a catalytic agent of social change in Kerala from the 19th century. Missionaries and the colonial state spread literacy and English knowledge. It undermined caste-based traditional learning and produced new reformers. The spread of education created a public sphere that fuelled anti-caste movements and nationalism.
17) The janmi system under British rule gave landlords absolute ownership rights. Tenants became tenants-at-will and faced heavy exploitation. British revenue

policies protected janmis for political stability. This strengthened caste-class hierarchy and triggered later agrarian unrest including Mappila outbreaks.

18) Reform movements challenged patriarchal customs through the SNDP Yogam and Nair Service Society. They attacked sambandham and marumakkathayam while advocating monogamy and women's education. Leaders like Narayana Guru and Chattampi Swamikal promoted gender equality. Legal changes such as the Nair Regulation of 1925 gradually empowered women.
19) Kallumaala Samaram was the 1915–16 anti-caste protest by Pulaya women in Travancore. They defied dress codes by wearing stone necklaces like upper-caste women. Ayyankali's followers led the struggle for dignity. The movement became a powerful symbol of lower-caste assertion and influenced later rights campaigns.
20) The Travancore State Congress faced severe state repression after its formation in 1938. Diwan C.P. Ramaswami Iyer ordered arrests, lathi charges and bans on meetings. Internal divisions limited its early mass base. Sustained Satyagraha and alliances eventually overcame these challenges and strengthened the demand for responsible government.
21) The Congress Socialist Party was formed in Malabar in 1934 due to discontent with moderate Congress leadership. The Great Depression and rising leftist ideas accelerated the split. Leaders such as EMS Namboodiripad and A.K. Gopalan pushed class-based programmes. The party radicalised the anti-feudal struggle in the region.
22) Politics in Kerala shifted from nationalist to class-based lines in the 1930s. Economic distress and peasant movements against janmis drove the change. The formation of the Congress Socialist Party marked the turning point. This shift strengthened communism and class consciousness in Malabar.

PART C – Essay Questions (Any 2 × 10 = 20 marks)

23) Colonialism profoundly impacted the Princely State of Travancore through indirect rule after the 1795 subsidiary alliance. Administration was modernised with a centralised bureaucracy and Dewan system. Revenue policy shifted to cash-based land tax and royal monopolies on cash crops. Social structure saw missionary education and reform movements that both challenged and initially reinforced inequalities. Overall state formation moved from feudalism to a modern princely state that later faced demands for responsible government. The process combined modernisation with economic exploitation.
24) Colonial agrarian legislation reinforced caste and class hierarchy by strengthening janmi rights. Laws gave landlords absolute ownership while tenants remained powerless. The Malabar Tenancy Act offered only partial relief and failed to end exploitation. Upper-caste janmis retained dominance over lower-caste tenants. This policy ensured colonial stability but sowed seeds for post-independence land reforms and agrarian unrest.
25) The Ottappalam Conference of 1921 and the Payyannur Conference of 1926 had contrasting goals. Ottappalam focused on Non-Cooperation and Khilafat unity with emphasis on anti-British boycott programmes. Payyannur shifted towards radical peasant issues and anti-feudal demands under emerging socialist influence. Ottappalam represented broad nationalist mobilisation while

Payyannur reflected the move to class-based politics. Together they show the evolution of Congress strategy in Malabar.

26) The American Model proposed by C.P. Ramaswami Iyer in the 1940s aimed at an American-style federal democracy for independent Travancore. It promised modern administration and efficient governance. However it ignored local feudal and caste realities and was seen as pro-British and anti-integration. The model proved unrealistic amid strong mass movements for responsible government. It was ultimately rejected and Travancore joined the Indian Union in 1949. The proposal symbolised elite resistance rather than genuine democratic feasibility.